Bookstore Performance & Publisher Insights

Q1 2024 sales review in Tableau: genres, regions and publishers

Paul O. Bankole · Data Analyst portfolio project

AT A GLANCE

Steady Q1 sales, led by the West and by History

$73.8K
Q1 sales from 750 orders

49.7%
of sales came from the West

$12.3K
History, the top genre

+11%
March sales vs February

What it means for Q2

- **Back the rising genres:** Mystery (+51% Jan→Mar), Non-Fiction (+34%) and Sci-Fi (+19%).
- **Investigate the declines:** Fiction (−27%) and Fantasy (−20%) fell across the quarter.
- **Lift the South:** 9.4% of sales and the lowest average order ($87).
- **Grow larger baskets:** orders of 5+ books are 41% of orders but 62% of sales.

PROJECT BRIEF

Which genres, regions and publishers to focus on in Q2

As a Junior Data Analyst for a national bookstore group selling across four US regions, I reviewed Q1 2024 performance in Tableau to guide Q2 marketing and purchasing.

Business questions

1. How did sales develop across Q1?
2. Which genres and regions performed best and worst?
3. Which publishers drive sales?
4. Where should Q2 marketing and purchasing focus?

Data provided

Bookstore_Monthly_Sales_2024_01.csv
250 orders · 1–28 Jan

Bookstore_Monthly_Sales_2024_02.csv
250 orders · 1–28 Feb

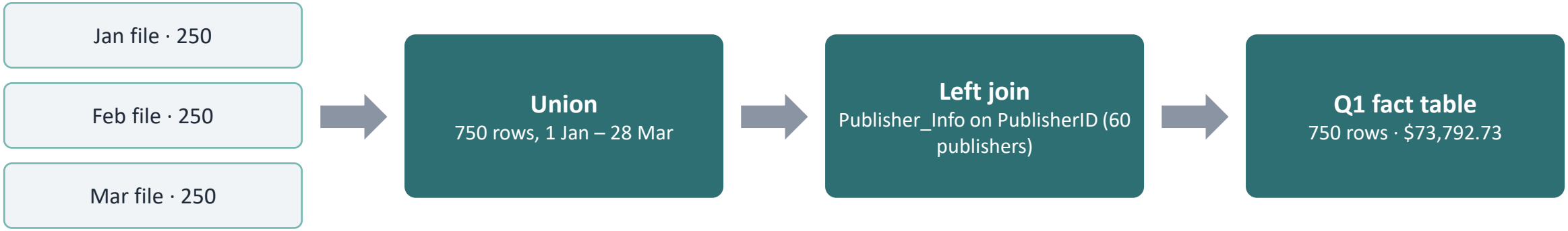
Bookstore_Monthly_Sales_2024_03.csv
250 orders · 1–28 Mar

Publisher_Info.csv
60 publishers

Bookstore_Sales.csv
700 orders, 2020–2024 (separate dataset)

DATA PREPARATION

Three monthly files unioned into one validated Q1 table



Calculated fields

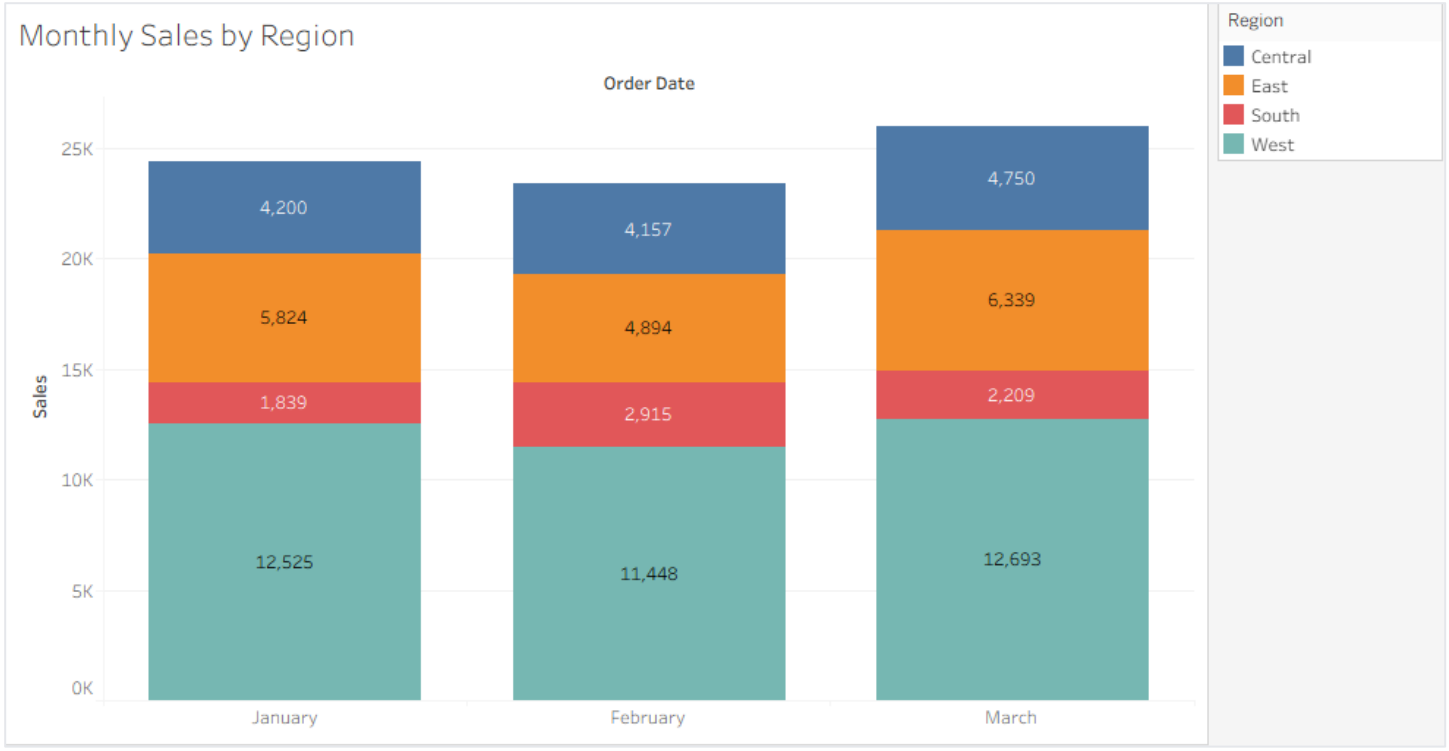
```
Avg. Sales per Order = SUM([Sales]) / COUNTD([OrderID])
Avg. Unit Price = SUM([Sales]) / SUM([Quantity])
Order Size = IF [Quantity] >= 5 THEN "Large (5+)"
   ELSEIF [Quantity] >= 3 THEN "Medium (3-4)"
   ELSE "Small (1-2)" END
```

Validation checks

- Row count and SUM(Sales) checked per source file (Table Name)
- No missing values; all 60 publishers matched
- One order ID (BM-03-493700) used for two orders
- Bookstore_Sales.csv not joined: a PublisherID join would create 8,704 rows

TREND

Sales held steady, with March the strongest month



$26.0K

March sales, up 11% on February ($23.4K) and above January ($24.4K)

4 of 4

regions sold in every month: there was no mid-quarter plateau

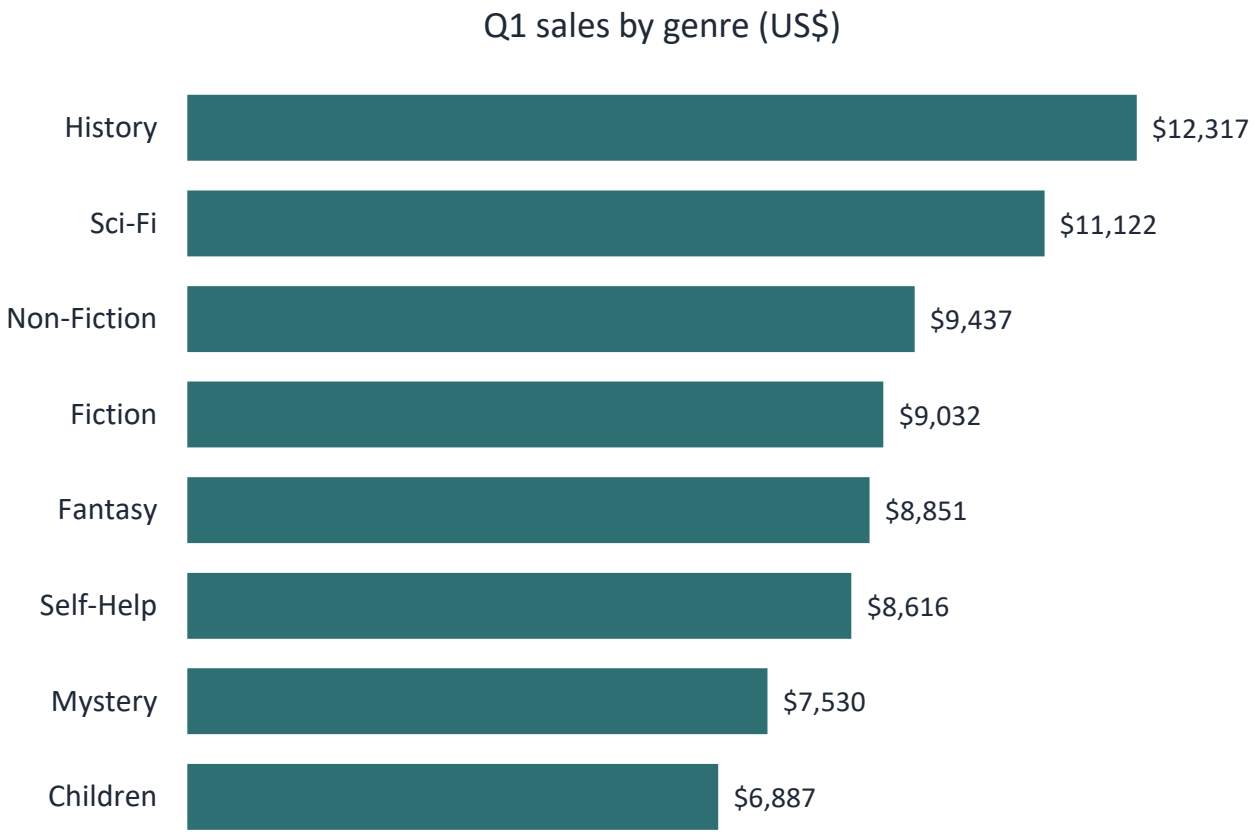
Feb

was the South's best month ($2.9K), the only region to peak then

Tableau worksheet: Monthly Sales by Region (US$). Each monthly file covers days 1–28, so months are compared rather than weeks.

GENRES

History leads; Mystery and Non-Fiction grow fastest



Change, January to March

Mystery	+51%
Non-Fiction	+34%
Sci-Fi	+19%
Children	+16%
History	+8%
Self-Help	+6%
Fantasy	−20%
Fiction	−27%

Source: Bookstore monthly sales files, Jan–Mar 2024.

REGIONS

The West delivers half of Q1 sales and leads every genre



West

$36.7K

360 orders · avg $102

East

$17.1K

174 orders · avg $98

Central

$13.1K

136 orders · avg $96

South

$7.0K

80 orders · avg $87

The South has the fewest orders and the smallest baskets, so growing order size matters as much as reach.

GENRE × REGION

Clear gaps: Non-Fiction in the South and Central regions

	Children	Fantasy	Fiction	History	Mystery	Non-Fiction	Sci-Fi	Self-Help
West	3,244	4,352	4,110	6,287	2,948	5,236	5,485	5,003
East	1,569	2,015	1,893	3,202	1,521	3,171	2,237	1,446
Central	1,129	1,699	2,071	1,598	2,140	874	2,065	1,530
South	945	785	957	1,229	921	156	1,334	636

Strongest
West History $6,287 and West Sci-Fi $5,485

Biggest gap
South Non-Fiction $156, the lowest cell by far

Also low
Central Non-Fiction $874 and South Fantasy $785

Q1 2024 sales in US$. Darker cells = higher sales.

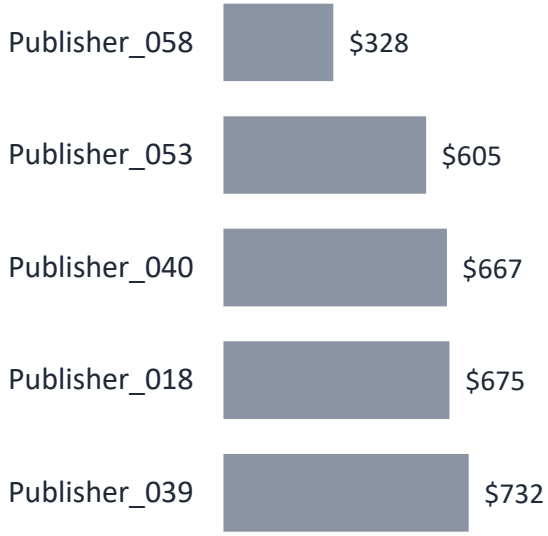
PUBLISHERS

Sales are spread widely: top 5 publishers hold 12.9%

Top 5 publishers, Q1 sales (US$)



Bottom 5 publishers, Q1 sales (US$)



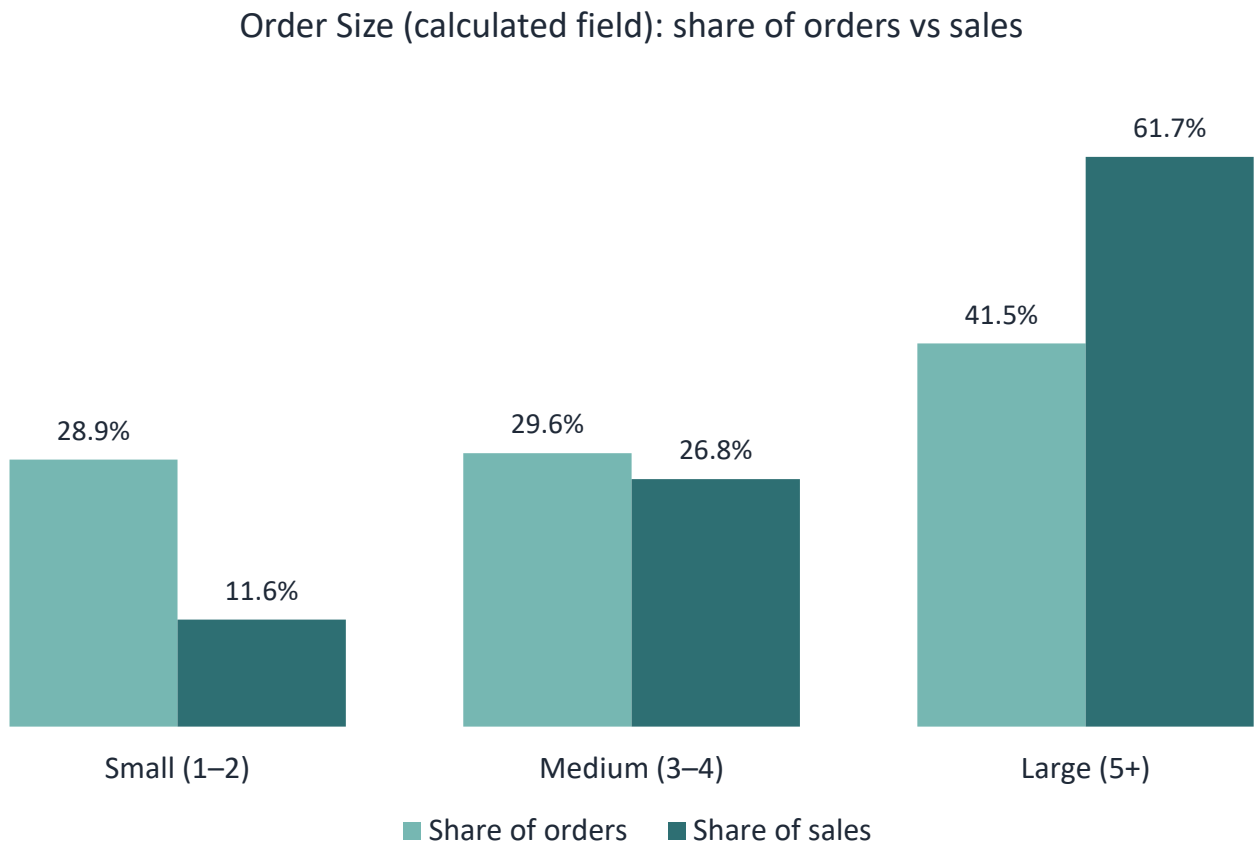
60 of 60 publishers had Q1 sales

12.9% of sales from the top 5

23.9% of sales from the top 10

ORDER SIZE

Orders of 5+ books are 41% of orders but 62% of sales



Average order value

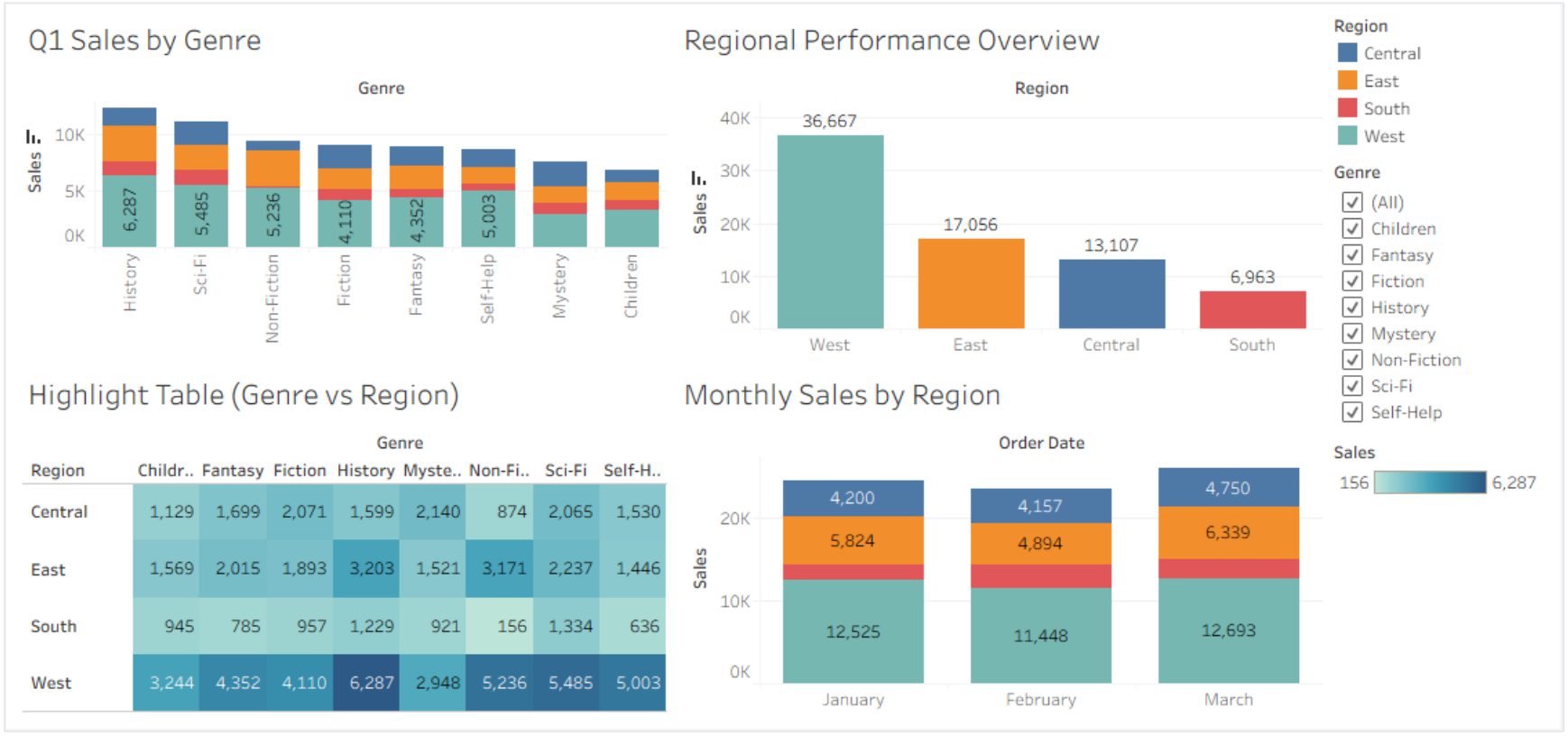
Small (1–2)	**$39**
Medium (3–4)	**$89**
Large (5+)	**$146**
All orders	**$98**

Multi-buy and bundle offers that move customers from medium to large baskets have the biggest effect on revenue.

750 Q1 orders; quantities range from 1 to 7 books. Largest single order: $311.85.

TABLEAU DASHBOARD

Executive dashboard: four linked views of Q1



Genre mix

Stacked bars show each genre's sales split by region

Regional totals

West, East, Central and South side by side

Highlight table

Colour scale picks out strong and weak genre-region cells

Monthly sales

Sales by month and region, showing a steady quarter

Filters by region and genre apply across all four views.

A different job for each region in Q2

Region	Q1 position	Q2 focus	Suggested actions
West	$36.7K (49.7%); leads all 8 genres	Protect and grow	Keep History, Sci-Fi and Non-Fiction well stocked; test loyalty offers on large orders
East	$17.1K (23.1%); strongest in History and Non-Fiction	Build on strengths	Feature History and Non-Fiction; lift Self-Help ($1.4K) and Mystery ($1.5K)
Central	$13.1K (17.8%); Mystery and Fiction lead	Close the Non-Fiction gap	Test Non-Fiction range and promotions ($874 in Q1); extend Mystery
South	$7.0K (9.4%); lowest average order ($87)	Activate and lift baskets	Bundles to raise order size; lead with Sci-Fi and History; review Non-Fiction ($156)

Figures are Q1 2024 sales in US$.

Back the risers, investigate the decliners

1 Back the rising genres

Increase range and visibility for Mystery (+51%), Non-Fiction (+34%) and Sci-Fi (+19%), the strongest growth from January to March.

2 Investigate Fiction and Fantasy

Both fell sharply (−27% and −20%). Check stock levels, new releases and pricing before cutting investment.

3 Grow larger baskets

Orders of 5+ books bring 62% of sales. Multi-buy offers can shift medium orders upward, especially in the South.

4 Broaden publisher partnerships

No publisher dominates. Deepen ties with the top 5 and review the range from the bottom 5 (e.g. Publisher_058, $328).

LIMITATIONS

What this analysis can and can't tell us

One quarter, partial months

Q1 only, and each file covers days 1–28, so seasonality and month-end sales are missing.

No Q1 cost or profit

Only Bookstore_Sales.csv has profit, and it covers different orders (2020–2024), so profitability isn't assessed.

Duplicate order ID

BM-03-493700 is used for two orders, so COUNTD(OrderID) returns 749 rather than 750.

Publishers not normalised

Rankings use raw sales and don't adjust for catalogue size or number of titles.

No customer data

Without customer or demographic data, the reasons behind regional differences remain unclear.

No external benchmark

Market share and competitor performance aren't included.

Thank you

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Open to Data Analyst and BI Analyst roles